

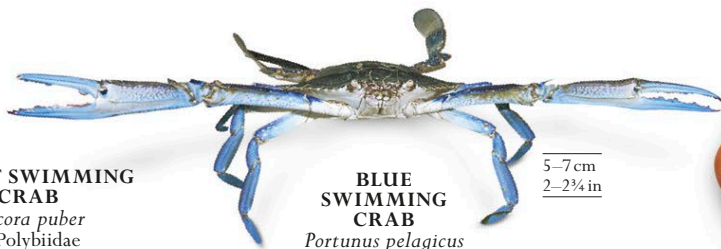


5–6.5 cm
2–2½ in

VELVET SWIMMING CRAB

Necora puber
F: Polybiidae

Swimming crabs have paddle-like rear legs. This aggressive, red-eyed species is common at low shore level on rocky coasts in the N.E. Atlantic.

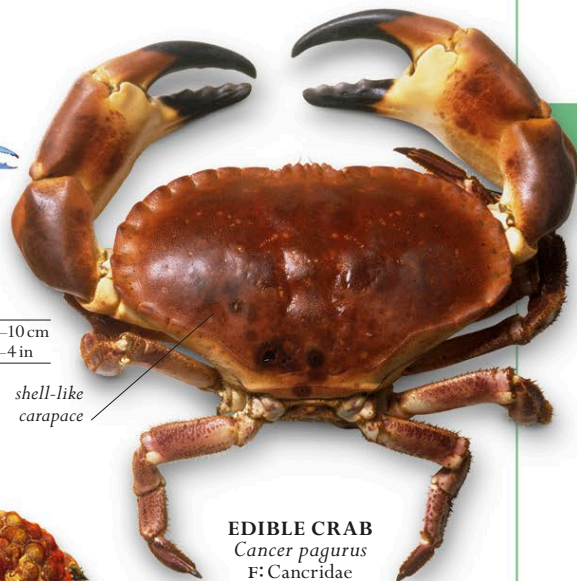


5–7 cm
2–2¼ in

BLUE SWIMMING CRAB

Portunus pelagicus
F: Portunidae

This Indo-Pacific swimming crab favours sandy or muddy coastlines, with juveniles entering the intertidal zone. Like its relatives, it preys on other invertebrates.



5–10 cm
2–4 in

shell-like
carapace

EDIBLE CRAB

Cancer pagurus
F: Cancridae

The most commercially important European crab, this offshore species has a distinctive wide “piecrust” carapace and can live for more than 20 years.

SPOTTED CORAL CRAB

Carpilius maculatus
F: Carpiliidae

One of several species of brightly coloured, coral-living crabs with many fossil relatives, this large species is found in the Indian and Pacific oceans.

4.5–9 cm
1¾–3½ in



WARTY BOX CRAB

Calappa hepatica
F: Calappidae

A tortoise-like crab, this Indo-Pacific, sand-burrowing species habitually shields its face with its claws, earning it the alternative name of shame-face crab.



4–6 cm
1½–2¼ in

4–5 cm
1½–2 in



SPONGE CRAB

Dromia personata
F: Dromiidae

This Atlantic crab often carries sponge pieces to hide itself from predators. Its reduced hind legs are like those of the related, primitive hermit crabs.



2–3 cm
¾–1¼ in

PAINTED PEBBLE CRAB

Leucosia anatum
F: Leucosiidae

Belonging to a family of small, mostly diamond-shaped crabs with long claws, this colourful species occurs in the Indian Ocean.



30–40 cm
12–16 in

JAPANESE SPIDER CRAB

Macrocheira kaempferi
F: Inachidae

With legs spanning 4 m (13 ft), this is the world's biggest arthropod. It occurs in N.W. Pacific waters and reputedly lives for up to 100 years.

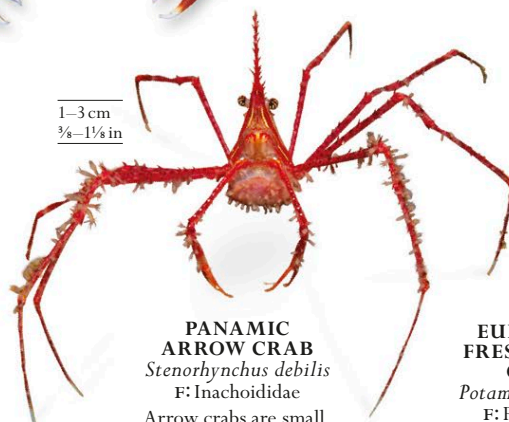


8–10 cm
3¼–4 in

CHRISTMAS ISLAND RED CRAB

Gecarcoidea natalis
F: Gecarcinidae

This land-living crab lives in burrows only in the forests of Christmas Island. Huge numbers march in an annual migration to the sea for spawning.



1–3 cm
¾–1½ in

PANAMIC ARROW CRAB

Stenorhynchus debilis
F: Inachoididae

Arrow crabs are small, stalk-eyed, spiky-headed spider crabs. This E. Pacific species is a reef-dwelling scavenger.

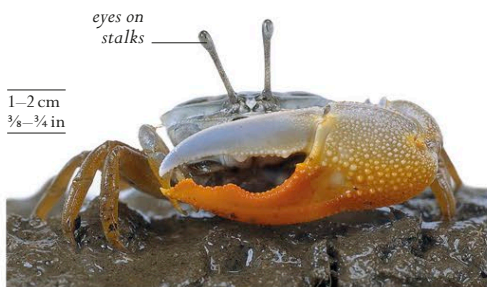


4–5 cm
1½–2 in

EUROPEAN FRESHWATER CRAB

Potamon potamios
F: Potamidae

A member of a large family of Eurasian crabs from alkaline fresh waters, this southern European species spends much of its time on land.

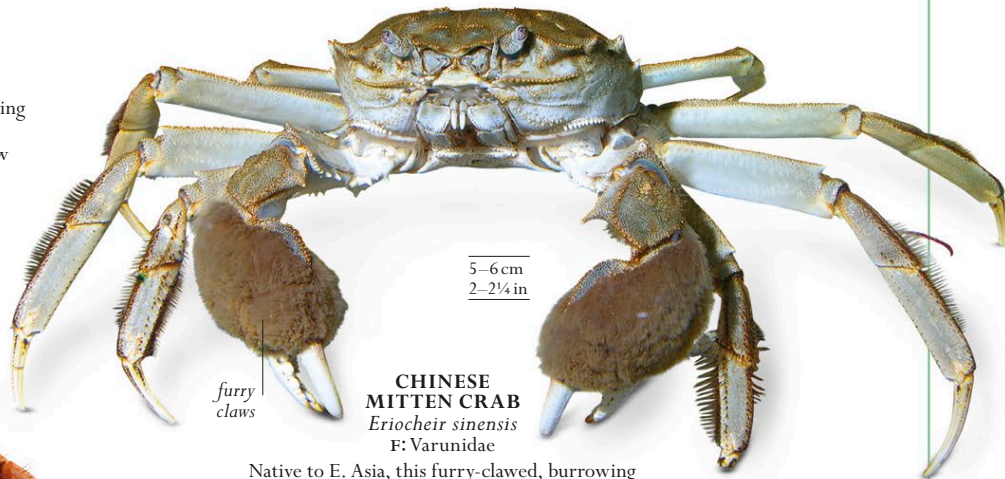


1–2 cm
¾–¾ in

ORANGE FIDDLER CRAB

Gelasimus vocans
F: Ocypodidae

Fiddler crabs are burrowing beach crabs with an enlarged signalling claw in males. This species lives on muddy W. Pacific shores.



5–6 cm
2–2¼ in

CHINESE MITTEN CRAB

Eriocheir sinensis
F: Varunidae

Native to E. Asia, this furry-clawed, burrowing river crab was introduced to N. America and Europe, where it has become a pest.

AFRICAN RAINBOW CRAB

Ocypode (Cardisoma) armatum
F: Ocypodidae

This shore-dwelling W. African species feeds on fruits, vegetation, and animals. Only females go into the sea to release eggs.

10–15 cm
4–6 in

